VIT Bhopal University
VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

Digital Literacy Portfolio

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

Name	Kunal Kumar
Registration No.	25BCE10196
Branch	CSE core
Year	First Year B.Tech
Course Code	CSE0001 'Digital Literacy'
Date	20 March 2026

Student Digital Ambassador Project

Introduction

This report documents my work as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As a first-year B.Tech. student selected as a Student Digital Ambassador, I was tasked with building a Digital Literacy Portfolio that would help my peers navigate the digital world responsibly and effectively.

The project is divided into five tasks, each corresponding to one module of the course. These tasks cover infographic design, professional digital profile creation, exploration of coding and collaboration platforms, professional email communication, and cybercrime awareness. Together, they form a practical introduction to the skills every engineering student needs in the modern workplace — not just technical ability, but digital communication, safety awareness, and professional presence online.

All work is organised in a single GitHub repository, which itself serves as a permanent part of my digital portfolio. This report explains what I did in each task, what I learned, and how I plan to use these skills in the future.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a one-page digital literacy infographic using Canva, a free browser-based design platform. Canva offers a wide range of templates, icons, and layout tools that made it possible to produce a professional-looking visual without any prior design experience.

My infographic is divided into three sections:

- The first section defines Digital Literacy and explains why it is important for students entering a technology-driven academic and professional environment.
- The second section focuses on building a professional online presence, with tips on maintaining clean, credible profiles on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub.
- The third section covers safe internet practices, including using strong passwords, identifying phishing attempts, and being cautious about what personal information is shared online.

The most interesting part of this task was learning how to communicate a complex topic visually — using icons, colour, and layout to guide the reader's eye and convey meaning without relying entirely on text. The most challenging aspect was limiting the content to what fits cleanly on one page, which forced me to prioritise the most important points. This experience taught me that effective digital communication is as much about what you leave out as what you include.

DIGITAL AGE SKILLS

STUDENT DIGITAL GUIDE

DIGITAL LITERACY

What is DIGITAL LITERACY ?

The ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies — effectively, safely, and responsibly.

KEY SKILLS

- Information Literacy
- Digital Communication
- Media Literacy
- Tech Fluency

Professional Online Presence

- Use professional profile photo
- Think before posting online
- Keep profiles updated regularly
- Be respectful and authentic
- Share achievements and projects
- Digital footprint impacts employers
- Join professional communities

Safe Use of INTERNET

- Use strong, unique passwords for every account
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication everywhere
- Think before you click — avoid phishing links
- Keep software & apps updated regularly
- Protect your personal information online

*Think Before You Click — Your Digital Footprint Matters

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct purpose in a student's professional digital identity.

GitHub is a code-hosting and version-control platform used by developers worldwide. I created my profile README with my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn during my degree. This profile will grow as I upload projects each semester, eventually becoming a portfolio that internship recruiters can review.

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. I filled in my Education section with my degree, institution, branch, and expected graduation year. This establishes a professional presence even before I have work experience.

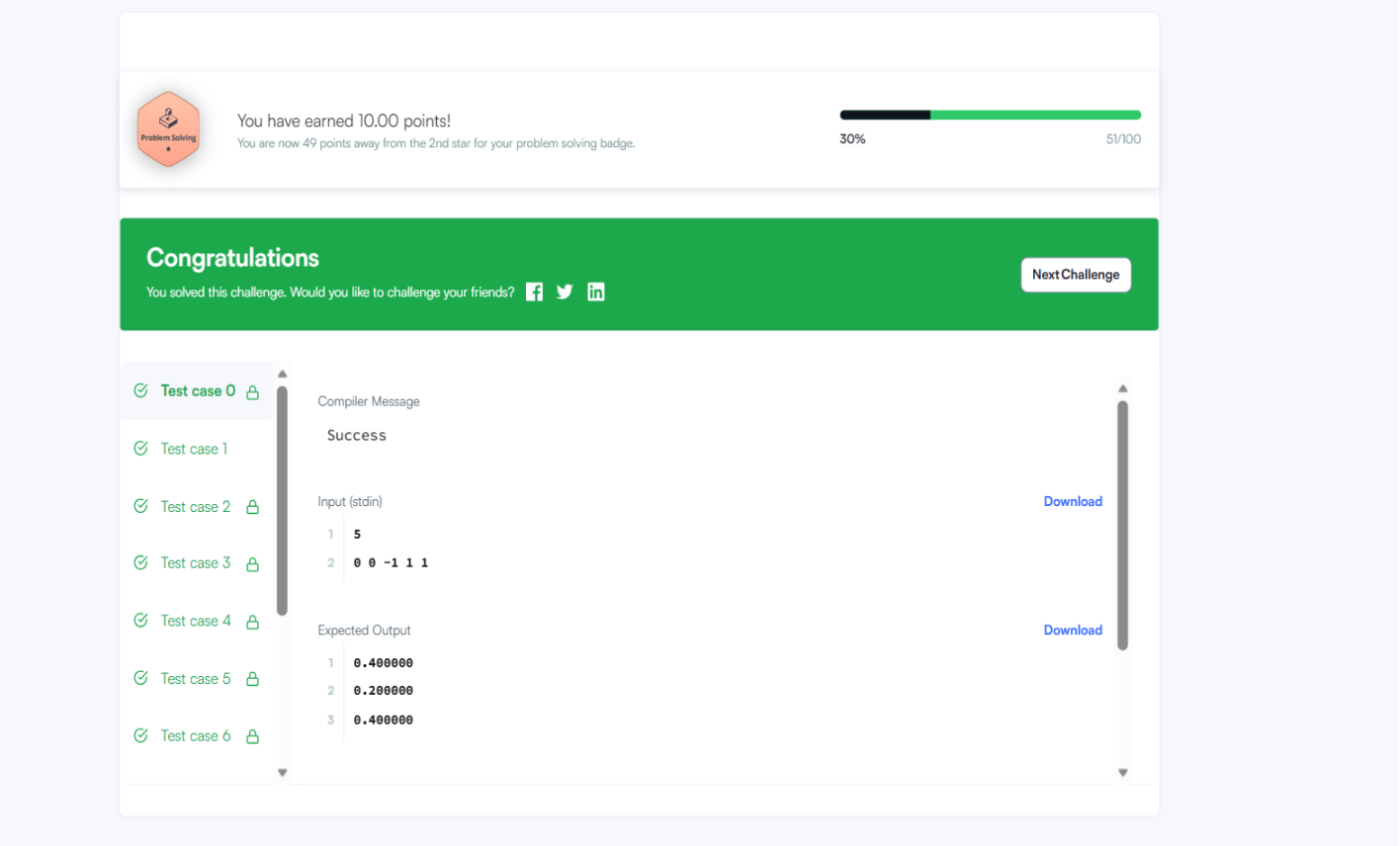
Kaggle is a data science and machine learning platform where students can practice with real datasets and participate in competitions. I chose it as my third platform because data literacy is becoming essential across all engineering disciplines.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively update my GitHub with coursework and personal projects, build my LinkedIn network by connecting with professors, seniors, and professionals, and attempt beginner-level data challenges on Kaggle to gradually strengthen my analytical and programming skills.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

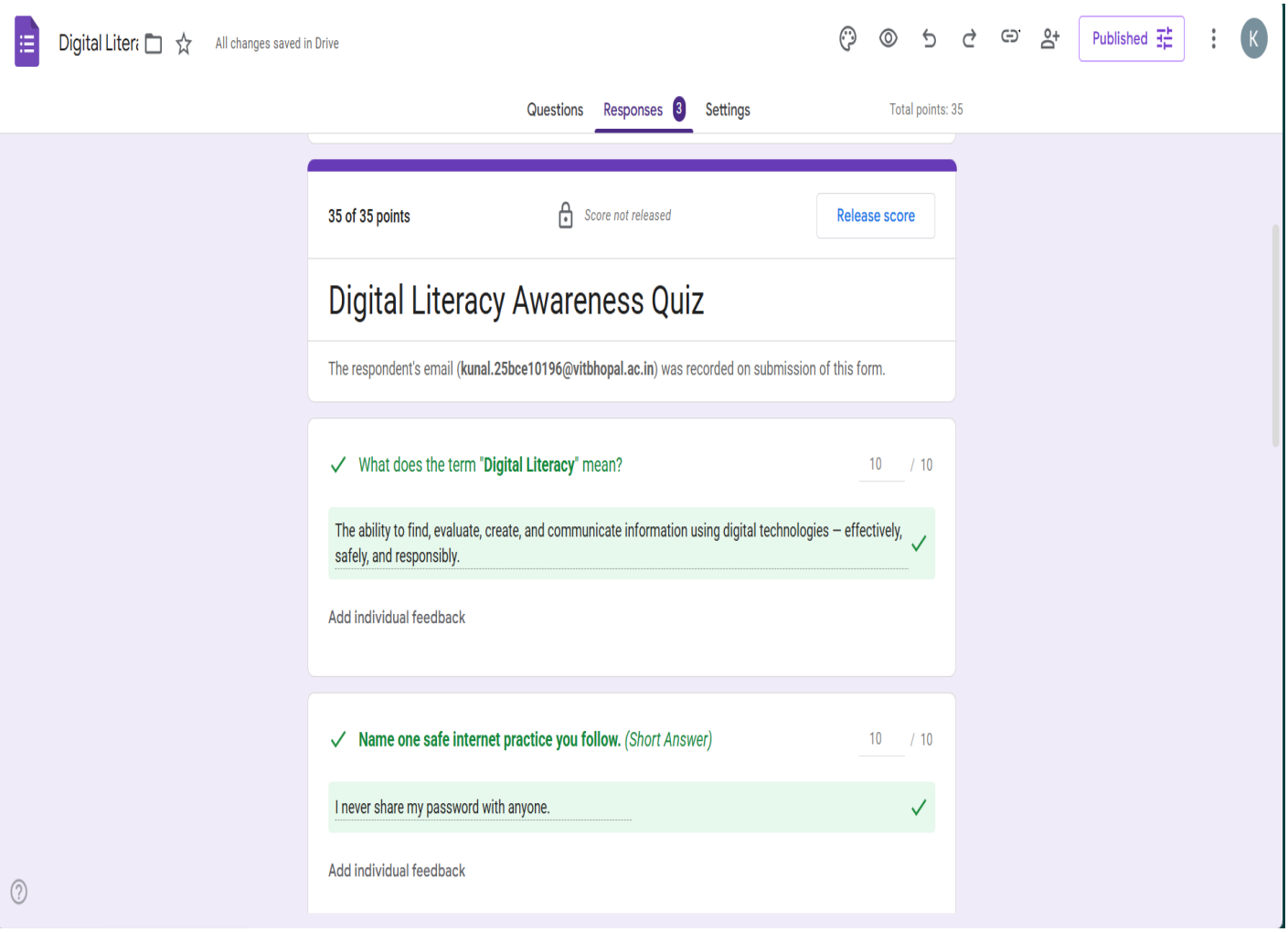
Task 3 introduced me to two categories of digital tools: coding practice platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools.

For Part A, I created an account on HackerRank and completed an introductory programming challenge. HackerRank provides a structured environment where students can practice coding in over 35 programming languages, with challenges ranging from beginner to advanced. Completing even a basic challenge showed me how online judges work — you write code, submit it, and the platform tests it against hidden test cases automatically. This is a skill I will need for technical interviews and coding assessments during internship applications.



For Part B, I created a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz includes multiple choice and short answer questions on topics such as phishing, safe internet practices, and professional platform usage. Google Forms automatically links to a Google Sheet that collects and organises responses, which introduces me to basic data collection and analysis workflows. I plan to share this form with my batchmates as a real Digital Ambassador activity.

These tools will help me academically by supporting both technical skill development and collaborative communication, which are two of the most valued capabilities in the technology industry.



Digital Liter: All changes saved in Drive

Published

Questions Responses 3 Settings

Total points: 35

✓ Which of the following is an example of phishing? 5 / 5

- ○ You log in to your university's official portal at https://vtop.vitbhopal.ac.in/vtop/login.
- ○ You install an extension directly from the Microsoft Edge Add-ons store (microsoftedge.microsoft.com/addons).
- ○ You receive an email from your university's official domain (e.g., @vitbhopal.ac.in) inviting you to a verified education fair.
- ◉ You click a link in an email that takes you to a suspicious site like qwerpdf.com/ext.html asking you to download a "free" extension. ✓

Add individual feedback

✓ Which platform is best used for professional networking? 5 / 5

- ○ Instagram – primarily for photo and lifestyle sharing.
- ◉ LinkedIn – designed for career growth, job searching, and professional networking. ✓
- ○ YouTube – mainly for video content and entertainment.
- ○ Snapchat – focused on short-lived social interactions.

✓ What should you do if you receive a suspicious email asking for your password? 5 / 5

- ○ Reply to the email and provide your password immediately.
- ○ Click the link in the email to verify your account.
- ◉ Ignore the email, delete it, and report it to your IT/security team. ✓
- ○ Forward the email to friends so they can be aware.

Add individual feedback

Submitted 3/21/26, 12:06 AM

Task 4 – Email Etiquette & Professional Communication

Task 4 focused on professional written communication — a skill that is often overlooked by students but is critically important in academic and professional settings.

Part - A

I drafted two emails:

- The first is from a student to a professor requesting an assignment deadline extension. Writing this email taught me the importance of a clear, specific subject line; a professional greeting that uses the recipient's correct title; a structured body that states the problem, provides a brief reason, and makes a specific, reasonable request; and a polite sign-off that includes all relevant identification details.

Email 1 – Requesting Assignment Deadline Extension

To: professor.kannan@vitbhopal.ac.in
Subject: Request for Assignment Deadline Extension – DIGITAL LITERACY – Kunal Kumar – 25BCE10196

Dear KANNAN sir,

I hope this email finds you well. I am Kunal Kumar, a first-year B.Tech. student in CSE core, with registration number 25BCE10196.

I am writing to respectfully request a short extension for the Assignment 2 submission, which is currently due on 23 January 2026. Due to internet connectivity issue at my hostel, I have been unable to complete the assignment to the given time limit.

I have already made significant progress on the task and I can submit a complete submission by next day or when you open google classroom task submission. I understand this is a request and entirely at your discretion.

I sincerely apologise for any inconvenience caused and assure you this will not affect my future submissions.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Yours sincerely,
Kunal Kumar
25BCE10196
B.Tech. “CSE core”

- The second email was addressed to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship. This email required a slightly more formal and persuasive tone, demonstrating enthusiasm and professionalism simultaneously.

Email 2 – Expressing Interest in a Summer Internship

To: internships@jpmorgan.com
Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity – B.Tech. CSE Student – VIT Bhopal

Dear Internship Coordinator,

I hope you are doing well. My name is Kunal Kumar, and I am currently pursuing my first year of B.Tech. in CSE core at VIT Bhopal University. I came across your organisation while researching summer internship opportunities in software development.

I am writing to express my strong interest in any summer internship positions you may have available for undergraduate students. I am eager to gain hands-on experience in a professional environment and to apply the concepts I have been learning in my coursework.

Although I am in the early stages of my degree, I am a quick learner with a keen interest in competitive programming and problem-solving. I would be grateful for the opportunity to contribute to your team and to learn from experienced professionals at your organisation.

I would welcome the chance to discuss any available opportunities. Please find my contact details below. I am happy to share any additional information or documents you may require.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,
Kunal Kumar
25BCE10196 | VIT Bhopal University
CSE core | B.Tech. First Year

PART B

A striking example of how poor digital communication can derail real opportunities involves a fresh graduate who applied for a marketing role at a mid-sized firm in Bengaluru. The candidate had a strong academic record and relevant project experience — on paper, he was a strong fit. However, his application email was sent from an address like `coolboy_rocky99@gmail.com`, the subject line simply read "job," and the body of the email began with "hey, I saw urn opening online." There was no mention of the specific role, no structured introduction, and no sign-off beyond his first name.

The recruiter later shared in a LinkedIn post that the email was flagged before the resume was even opened. The informal address, lowercase writing, and texting-style abbreviations immediately signalled that the applicant had not taken the application seriously — or worse, that this was simply how he communicated professionally.

The candidate could have avoided this entirely with three basic steps: using a formal email ID containing his actual name, writing a subject line that clearly identified the role he was applying for, and structuring the body with a proper greeting, a brief introduction, and a professional sign-off.

The lesson here is straightforward — in professional settings, how you write is read as a reflection of how you think and work. A careless email does not just lose you a reply. It loses you the opportunity before anyone has looked at your qualifications.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

For Task 5, I researched phishing as a cybercrime type and wrote a case study based on a realistic scenario involving fraudulent scholarship emails targeting university students in India. Phishing involves tricking people into revealing sensitive information — such as passwords or banking details — by impersonating a trusted source.

What surprised me most during this research was how technically simple phishing attacks actually are. The attackers do not need advanced hacking skills — they simply create a convincing-looking fake website and send bulk emails. What makes it effective is psychological manipulation: the use of urgency, authority, and fear. The scholarship scenario was particularly alarming because it targets students who may already be financially vulnerable, and the losses — often ₹8,000 to ₹15,000 — can represent an entire month's stipend.

The one personal habit I will change as a result of this research is to never click any link in an email that asks me to verify financial or login information — regardless of how official it looks. I will always go directly to the official website by typing the URL manually. I have also saved the Cyber Crime Helpline number (1930) on my phone, so I can act quickly if I or anyone I know ever becomes a victim.

Conclusion

This project has given me a comprehensive introduction to the digital skills that are essential for a student entering the modern, technology-driven world. Across the five tasks, I learned how to communicate ideas visually, build and maintain a professional online presence, use industry-standard platforms for coding and collaboration, write clearly and professionally in digital communication, and recognise and protect myself from online threats.

Beyond the individual tasks, the most valuable outcome is the GitHub repository itself — a living, growing portfolio that I will continue to build throughout my degree. Every line of code, every project, and every reflection I add to it makes me more visible and more competitive as a future professional. This project has set the foundation. The next four years will build on it.

References

- Canva – canva.com (Infographic design tool)
- GitHub – github.com (Code repository and portfolio platform)
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com (Professional networking platform)
- Kaggle – kaggle.com (Data science practice platform)
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (Coding practice platform)
- Google Forms – forms.google.com (Survey and quiz creation tool)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) – cert-in.org.in
- VIT Bhopal University – vitbhopal.ac.in

Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7, Government of India)